SETTING · D&D 2024

The City of Tears

Hallownest's capital, drowned in a rain that has fallen for a hundred years. Its nobles still keep their manners, long after their minds have gone.

V0.1 PLAYTEST LOCATION SKETCH INSPIRED BY HOLLOW KNIGHT

What It Is

The capital lies beneath the Blue Lake, whose waters seep through the cavern roof in an endless, gentle rain. Grand stone towers rise over lamplit streets, stately mansions, and the stations of the King's old tramways. When the Infection came, the city's great and good locked their doors and waited for the King to save them. He never came. Husk nobles still stroll the avenues in fine coats, husk sentries still walk their rounds, and the city's three great towers still hold its most dangerous minds.

The Rain

The rain never stops. Areas more than 30 feet away are Lightly Obscured, and creatures have Disadvantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing. Nonmagical open flames gutter out after 1 minute; lumafly lanterns, sold all over the city, never do.

The Dreamer's Seal

Lurien the Watcher sleeps atop the Watcher's Spire. He's one of three Dreamers whose endless dreams hold the seal on the Black Egg Temple. A character who reaches him with a dream nail or a *dream* spell can break his seal. Each Dreamer's seal broken opens the Temple a little further, and raises the DC of every Infection saving throw in Hallownest by 1. Breaking all three opens the way to the Hollow Knight, and to the Radiance.

Places of Note

- **The Watcher's Spire.** A great tower guarded by the Watcher Knights, Lurien's loyal bodyguards, who still fight as one. At its peak, Lurien sleeps beside his telescope.
- **The Soul Sanctum.** A gleaming hall of scholars who learned to harvest soul from the living, and never stopped. The Soul Master still experiments within.
- **The King's Station.** The city's grand stagway station. If the bell still rings, the last of the great stags may answer.
- **The Pleasure House.** An elegant bathhouse where a famous singer once performed every night. Her ghost still does.
- **The Tower of Love.** A sealed tower, locked by a key hidden elsewhere in the kingdom. Inside, the Collector keeps everything it loves in jars.
- **The Fountain of the Vessel.** A monument at the city's heart to the Hollow Knight, with an inscription that's harder to read the longer you look at it.

Who You Meet

- **Relic Seeker Lemm,** a gruff, history-obsessed shopkeeper who buys relics of Hallownest and has very strong opinions about the Pale King.
- **Lurien the Watcher,** the sleeping Dreamer, met only in dreams: gentle, lonely, and devoted to a king who left him behind.
- **The Soul Master,** brilliant, unhinged, and convinced that one more experiment will make him a god.

- **The Collector,** a gleeful, void-touched creature who "protects" whatever it captures, mostly grubs, by keeping them in jars forever.
- **Marissa,** the ghost of the Pleasure House's singer, who still performs for an audience that's long since gone.
- **Emilitia,** a fading noble who'll do anything to be admitted to the old court's last private bath, including lie to the party.

Rain on the Capital

Roll once per day the party spends in the city.

D6	EVENT
1	**Polite Husks.** A pair of husk nobles bow to the party and continue an argument that ended a century ago. They attack if interrupted.
2	**Sentry Patrol.** Husk sentries sweep the street with lanterns, and they still arrest trespassers.
3	**Downpour.** The rain thickens for an hour. Areas more than 10 feet away are Lightly Obscured.
4	**A Relic.** A wandering journal, seal, or idol lies in the gutter. Lemm will pay well for it.
5	**Soul Leak.** A mage escaped from the Sanctum, crackling with stolen soul, flees something worse.
6	**A Song.** Faint singing drifts from the Pleasure House. Anyone who follows it finds the doors open.

Adventure Hooks

1. The Seer asks the party to break Lurien's seal. The Watcher Knights, and Lurien's dream, have other ideas.
2. The Collector has taken a grub from a desperate family, and the key to the Tower of Love is somewhere in the city.
3. Lemm will trade a priceless map of Hallownest for a relic locked in the Soul Sanctum's deepest vault.

Tie-ins

Soul Sanctum (the Sanctum and the Soul Master), Warrior of the Void (the Collector and the Dreamers' seal), and Oath of the Pale Throne (the court that waited for its king). For the kingdom around the city, including the Infection rules, see Hallownest.

Take a long rest, we'll wake you for the loot.

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